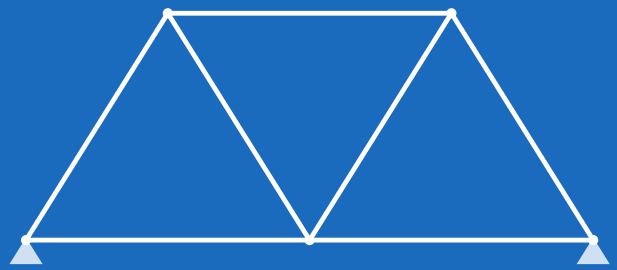
TRUSS REPORT

Warren truss

Plane truss — analysis and CIRSOC 301 rod checks

Author A. Student · Course Structures I · 13/10/2026



MAX TENSION	MAX COMPRESSION	DEFLECTION	MOST USED ROD	BUCKLING Λ_1	WEIGHT
+37.5 kN	-70.8 kN	5.0 mm	1.87	0.68	252 kg
rod 5	rod 0	L/2011 · limit L/300	rod 0 · elastic buckling (E3-3	BELOW 1 — buckles first	carries 120.0 kN · 49× own weight

The model

Span	10.00 m
Height	4.00 m
Nodes / rods	5 / 7
Supports	pin at 0, rollerX at 4
Loads	3 nodal, total 120.0 kN
Rod families	2, with their sections:
Chord	CHS 88.9x4.0, F24 (CIRSOC) / A36
Web	CHS 76.1x3.6, F24 (CIRSOC) / A36

What the analysis found

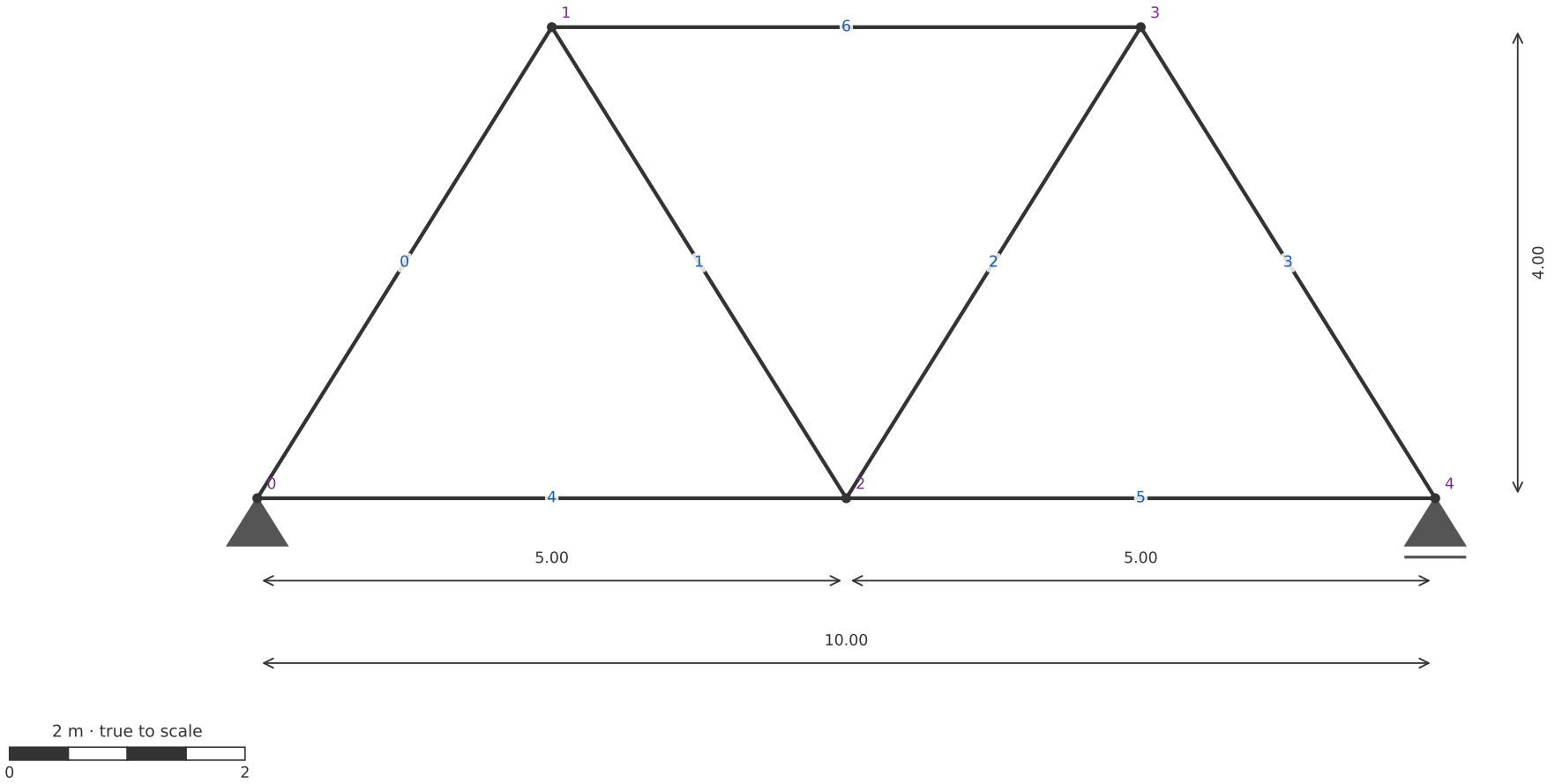
Stability	Statically determinate (m + r − 2j = 7 + 3 − 2×5 = 0): statics alone gives every force.
Most used rod	rod 0 at 1.87 (elastic buckling (E3-3)) — OVER CAPACITY
Rods over capacity	2 of 7 checked
Buckling	λ_1 = 0.68 — BELOW 1, it buckles before the full load is on
Shear and moment	none: every rod is pinned and loaded only at its nodes, so the axial force is the whole result

Contents

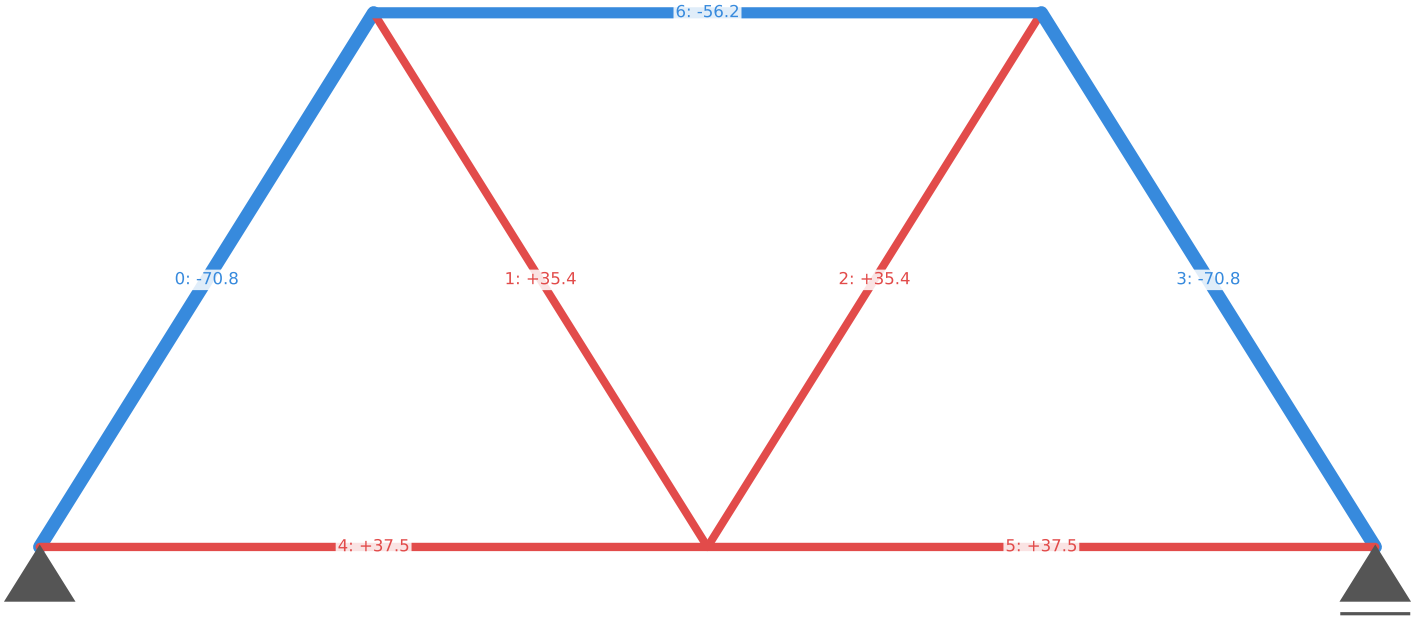
2 Geometry
3 Axial forces
4 Deflection and stress
5 Reactions
6 Utilisation
7 Buckling
8 Node force vectors
9 Rods
10 Rod calculations
11 Explain rod 0 and 3

Results are an aid to a qualified professional, who must check them. Rod checks to CIRSOC 301 as implemented; first-order analysis; joints and connections are not checked here.

Node numbers in purple, rod numbers in blue. Dimensions in m.



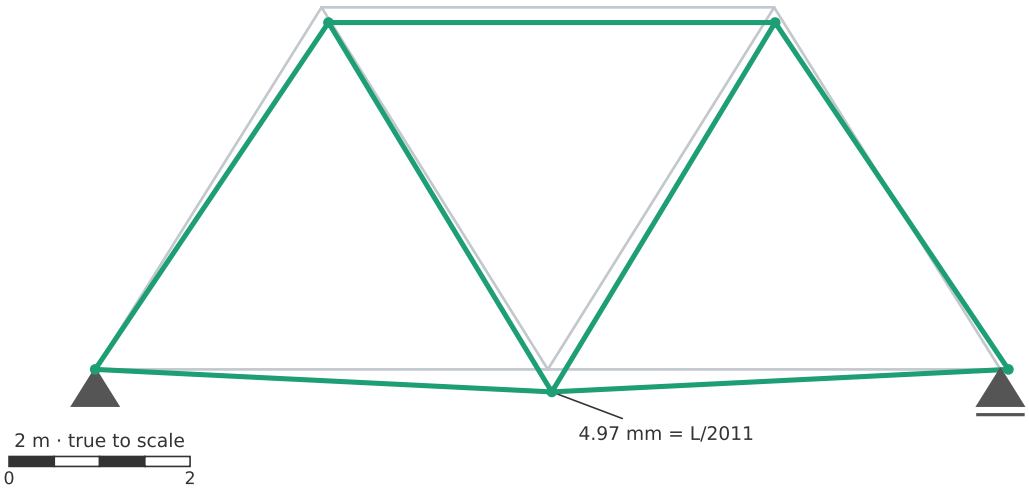
Axial force N (kN): red pulls (+), blue pushes (−), grey carries nothing; line width follows |N| (largest 70.8).



2 m · true to scale

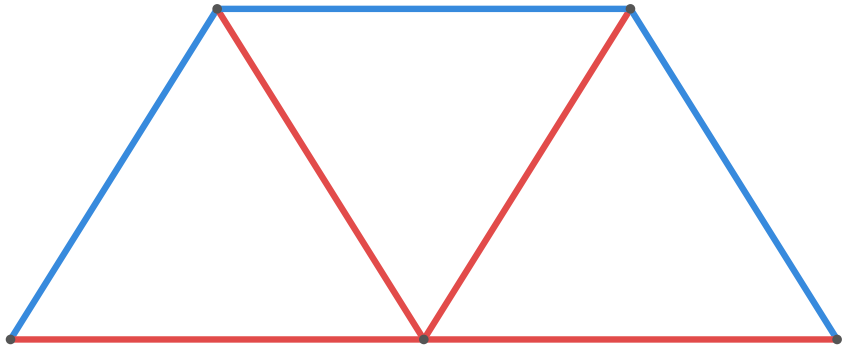
0 2

Elastic line: the deflected shape (green) over the truss (grey), every rigid rod drawn as the curve it bends into. Geometry to scale; displacements magnified × 50. Every rod is pinned, so every member stays straight: there is no curvature, and no contraflexure. Largest vertical deflection 4.97 mm against the limit L/300 = 33.3 mm: OK.

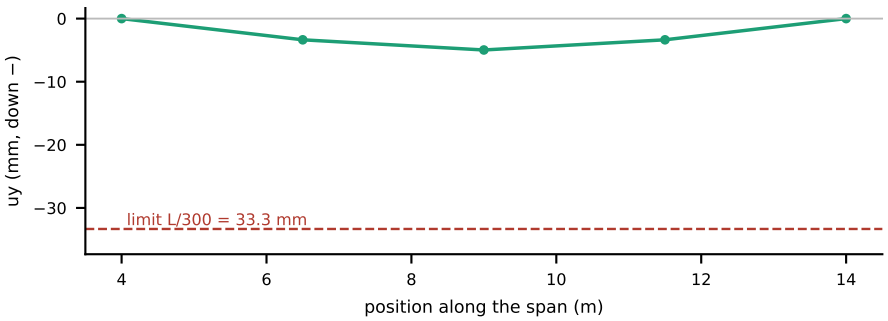


Fibre stress top and bottom face of each member

red = tension, blue = compression. Every rod is pinned, so both faces of a rod carry the same stress and each rod is one colour: the axial force.

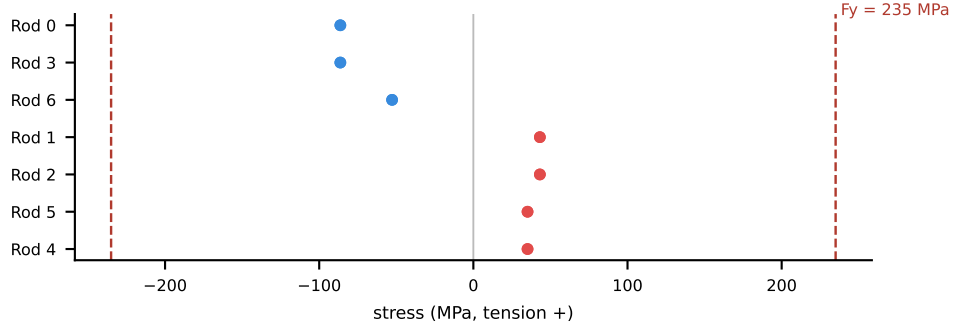


Deflection along the span vertical movement of every joint



Largest 4.97 mm at joint 2 = L/2011. Within the limit.

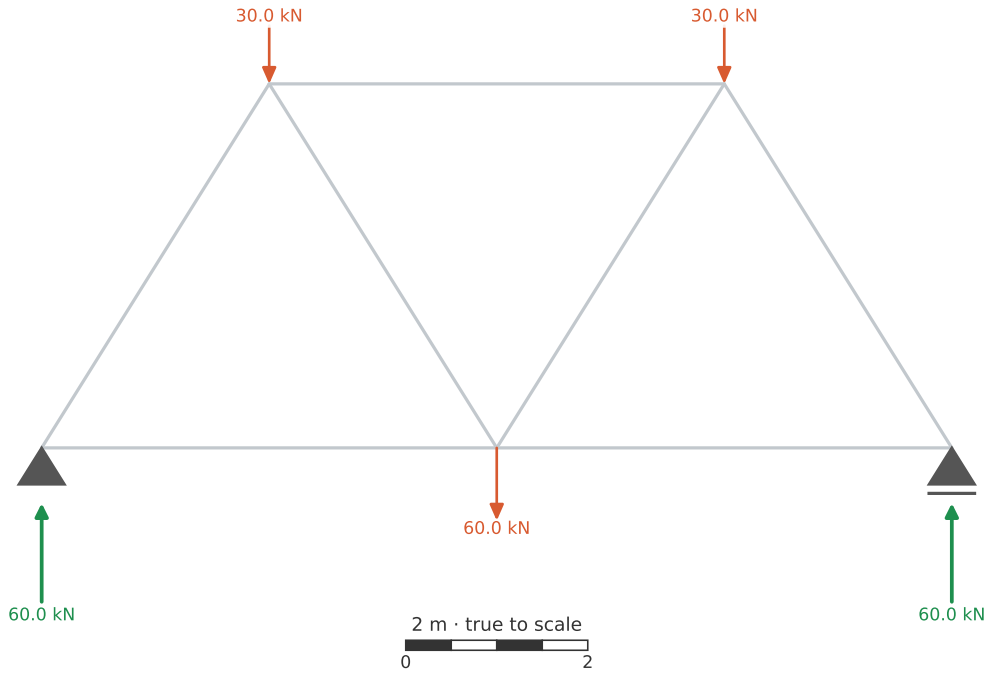
Fibre stress values the two faces of each rod, MPa



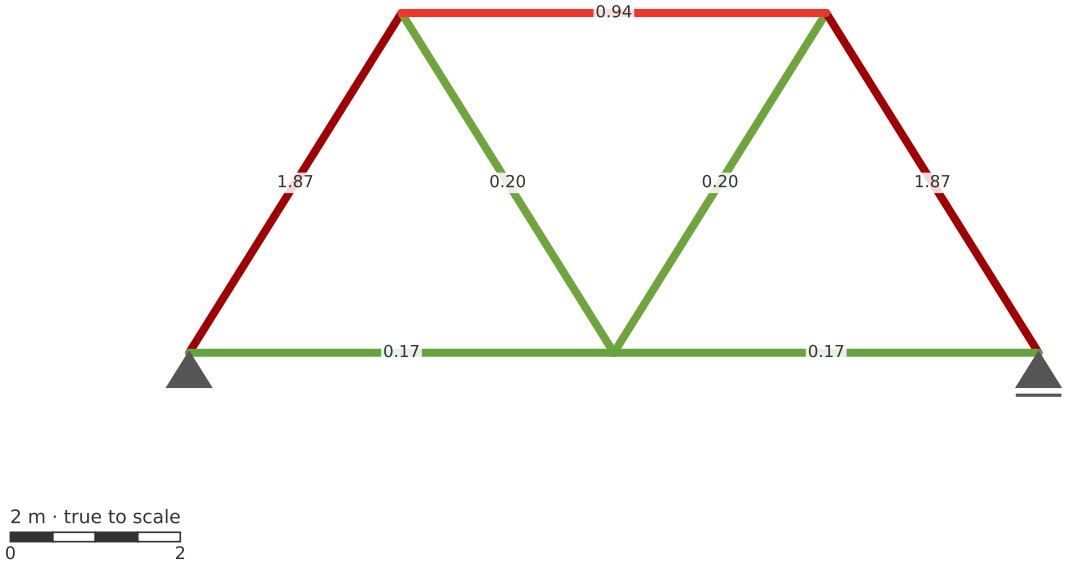
Every rod is pinned, so its two fibres carry the same N/A and coincide: no bending opens the pair.

Support reactions (green arrows), as the supports push on the truss, against the loads (orange); Ry positive upwards. The sums balance the loads.

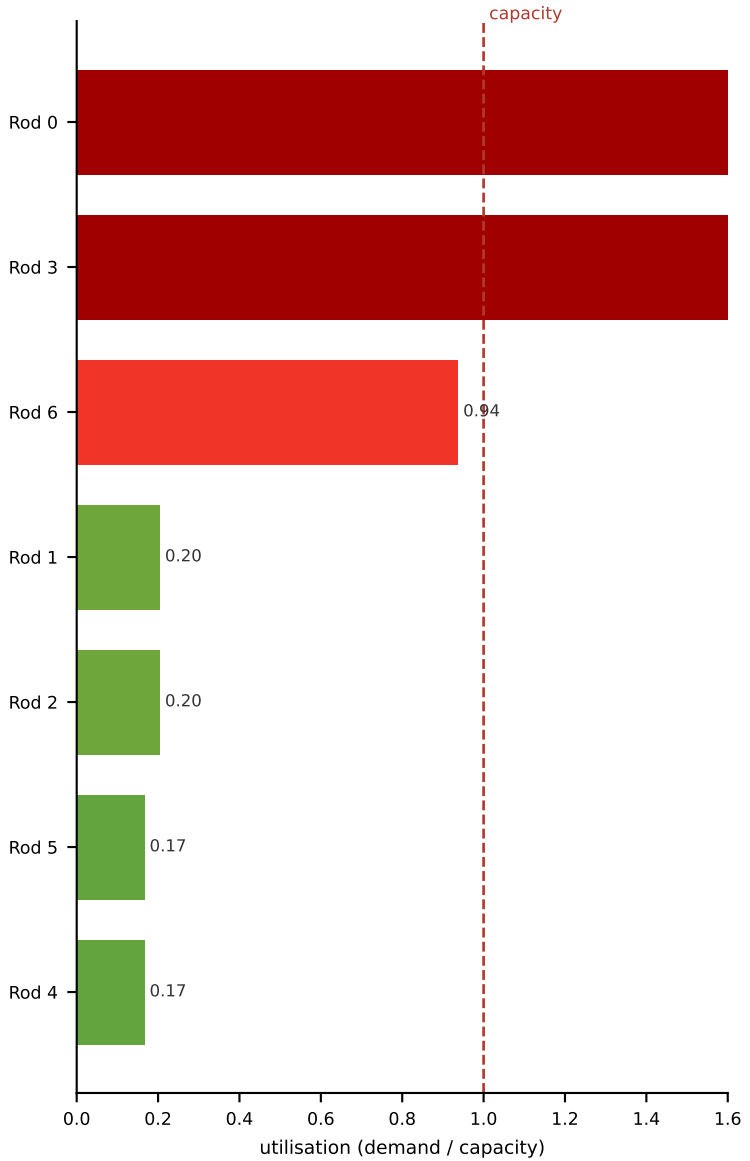
Node	Type	Rx (kN)	Ry (kN)
0	pin	0.00	60.00
4	rollerX	0.00	60.00
Σ		0.00	120.00

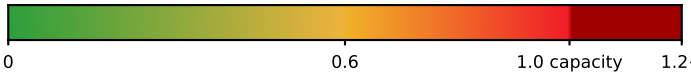


Utilisation: demand over CIRSOC 301 capacity. Most used rod 0 at 1.87 (elastic buckling (E3-3)). 2 rod(s) OVER capacity: 0, 3.



2 m · true to scale
0 2

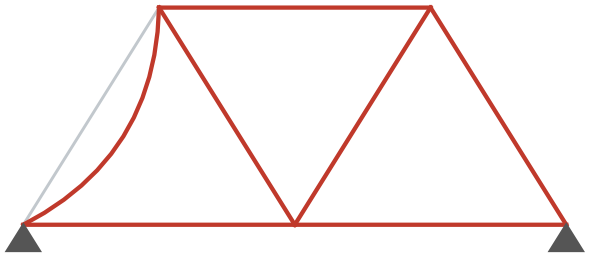




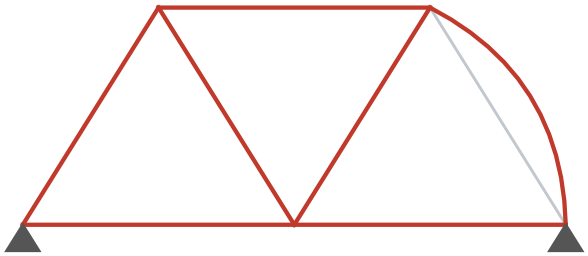
grey = no steel section, not checked

λ is the factor on the load as it stands. $\lambda_1 = 0.68$ is BELOW 1: it buckles before the full load is on. 2 modes share that λ: that many equal members buckle at the same load, so stiffening one of them buys nothing.

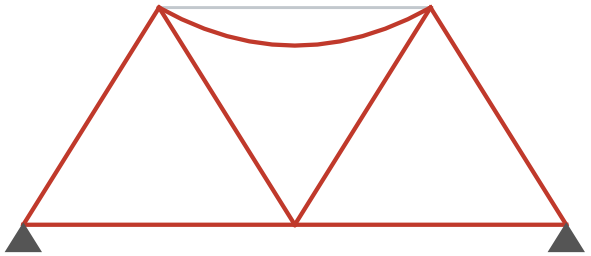
Mode 1: λ = 0.68
rod 0 bows

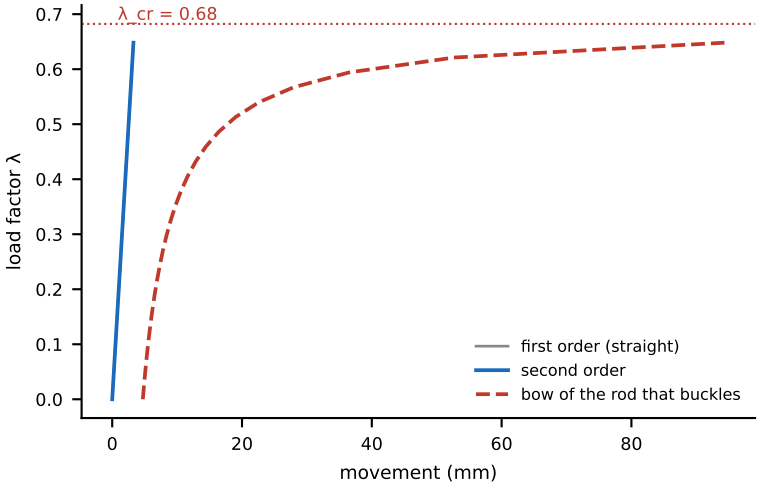


Mode 2: λ = 0.68
rod 3 bows



Mode 3: λ = 1.36
rod 6 bows





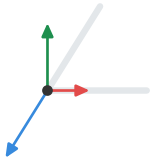
The second-order line bends away from the first-order one and runs off as λ nears λ_cr: that gap IS the amplification every second-order design rule is about. Started from an initial bow of L/1000 = 4.72 mm in the first mode's shape.

Elastic buckling of the IDEAL truss, so every λ is an UPPER bound: imperfections, residual stresses and yielding are not modelled, and each rod is cut in two so it can bow between its joints. Buckling OUT of the plane is the rod check's job (CIRSOC 301 E3, minor radius) and is in the Utilisation and Rods sheets, not here. A mode has a shape, not a size: the shapes are drawn exaggerated.

Every force ON each joint, drawn from its centre: each member's pull (red, tension) or push (blue, compression), the load (orange), the reaction (green). x right, y up, θ anticlockwise from +x. Σ ≈ 0: the joint is in equilibrium; these are the forces its gusset plate is designed for.

Joint 0 · pin

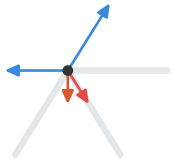




member	N	θ°	Fx	Fy
r0→1	-70.8	238.0	-37.5	-60.0
r4→2	+37.5	0.0	+37.5	+0.0
reaction			+0.0	+60.0
Σ kN	Fx 0.00	Fy 0.00	✓	

Joint 1

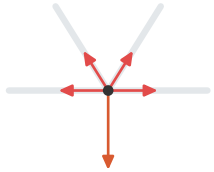




member	N	θ°	Fx	Fy
r0→0	-70.8	58.0	+37.5	+60.0
r1→2	+35.4	302.0	+18.8	-30.0
r6→3	-56.2	180.0	-56.2	+0.0
load			+0.0	-30.0
Σ kN	Fx 0.00	Fy 0.00	✓	

Joint 2

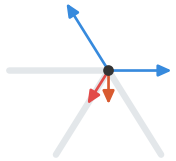




member	N	θ°	Fx	Fy
r1→1	+35.4	122.0	-18.8	+30.0
r2→3	+35.4	58.0	+18.8	+30.0
r4→0	+37.5	180.0	-37.5	+0.0
r5→4	+37.5	0.0	+37.5	+0.0
load			+0.0	-60.0
Σ kN	Fx 0.00	Fy 0.00	✓	

Joint 3

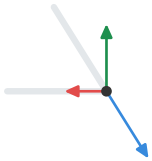




member	N	θ°	Fx	Fy
r2→2	+35.4	238.0	-18.8	-30.0
r3→4	-70.8	122.0	-37.5	+60.0
r6→1	-56.2	0.0	+56.2	+0.0
load			+0.0	-30.0
Σ kN	Fx 0.00	Fy 0.00	✓	

Joint 4 · rollerX





member	N	θ°	Fx	Fy
r3→3	-70.8	302.0	+37.5	-60.0
r5→2	+37.5	180.0	-37.5	+0.0
reaction			+0.0	+60.0
Σ kN	Fx 0.00	Fy 0.00	✓	

Every rod: its end nodes, family and steel section, length, axial force N (+ pulls, − pushes), the CIRSOC 301 check that governs it and how much of its capacity that uses (Use = demand / capacity; OVER above 1.0).

Rod	Nodes	Family	Section	L (m)	N (kN)	Governing check	Use	
0	0–1	Web	CHS 76.1x3.6	4.72	-70.75	elastic buckling (E3-3)	1.87	OVER
1	1–2	Web	CHS 76.1x3.6	4.72	+35.38	normal stress (H.3.4)	0.20	OK
2	2–3	Web	CHS 76.1x3.6	4.72	+35.38	normal stress (H.3.4)	0.20	OK
3	3–4	Web	CHS 76.1x3.6	4.72	-70.75	elastic buckling (E3-3)	1.87	OVER
4	0–2	Chord	CHS 88.9x4.0	5.00	+37.50	normal stress (H.3.4)	0.17	OK
5	2–4	Chord	CHS 88.9x4.0	5.00	+37.50	normal stress (H.3.4)	0.17	OK
6	1–3	Chord	CHS 88.9x4.0	5.00	-56.25	elastic buckling (E3-3)	0.94	OK

Every rod: its length L and angle θ (anticlockwise from +x, from its first joint to its second), its axial force N (+ pulls, − pushes), and what that force does at each end: Fx = N cos θ, Fy = N sin θ on the first joint, and the same reversed on the second. Right: the free body of each end joint, with this rod's force coloured and the rest grey.

Rod 0

joint 0 → 1

compression



```
L = 4.717 m     θ = 58.0°
cos θ = +0.530   sin θ = +0.848
N = -70.75 kN
at 0:  Fx = -37.50   Fy = -60.00
at 1:  Fx = +37.50   Fy = +60.00
```

joint 0 joint 1



Rod 1

joint 1 → 2

tension



```
L = 4.717 m     θ = 302.0°
cos θ = +0.530   sin θ = -0.848
N = +35.38 kN
at 1:  Fx = +18.75   Fy = -30.00
at 2:  Fx = -18.75   Fy = +30.00
```

joint 1 joint 2



Rod 2

joint 2 → 3

tension



```
L = 4.717 m     θ = 58.0°
cos θ = +0.530   sin θ = +0.848
N = +35.38 kN
at 2:  Fx = +18.75   Fy = +30.00
at 3:  Fx = -18.75   Fy = -30.00
```

joint 2 joint 3



Rod 3

joint 3 → 4

compression



```
L = 4.717 m     θ = 302.0°
cos θ = +0.530   sin θ = -0.848
N = -70.75 kN
at 3:  Fx = -37.50   Fy = +60.00
at 4:  Fx = +37.50   Fy = -60.00
```

joint 3 joint 4



Rod 4

joint 0 → 2

tension



```
L = 5.000 m     θ = 0.0°
cos θ = +1.000   sin θ = +0.000
N = +37.50 kN
at 0:  Fx = +37.50   Fy = +0.00
at 2:  Fx = -37.50   Fy = +0.00
```

joint 0 joint 2



Rod 5

joint 2 → 4

tension



```
L = 5.000 m     θ = 0.0°
cos θ = +1.000   sin θ = +0.000
N = +37.50 kN
at 2:  Fx = +37.50   Fy = +0.00
at 4:  Fx = -37.50   Fy = +0.00
```

joint 2 joint 4



Rod 6

joint 1 → 3

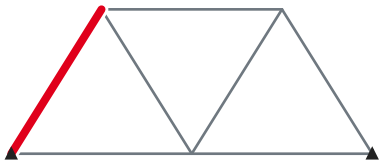
compression



```
L = 5.000 m     θ = 0.0°
cos θ = +1.000   sin θ = +0.000
N = -56.25 kN
at 1:  Fx = -56.25   Fy = +0.00
at 3:  Fx = +56.25   Fy = +0.00
```

joint 1 joint 3





Rod 0

utilisation 1.87 OVER

elastic buckling (E3-3)

```
Rod 0
=====
Steel, CIRSOC 301-2018 -- A = 820 mm², Fy = 235 MPa, L = 4.717 m

 1. Slenderness  [E2]
      K·L / r
      = 1 × 4,717 mm / 25.7 mm
      = 183.8

 2. Euler stress  [E3-4]
      Fe = π² E / (KL/r)²
      = π² × 200,000 / 183.8²
      = 58.43 MPa

 3. Which branch  [E3]
      KL/r ≤ 4.71 √(E/Fy) ?
      = 183.8 vs 4.71 √(200,000/235) = 137.4
      = elastic

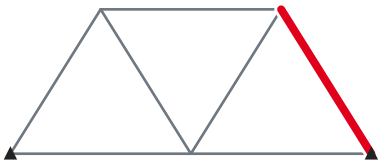
 4. Critical stress  [E3-3]
      Fcr = 0.877 · Fe
      = 0.877 × 58.43
      = 51.25 MPa

 5. Design strength  [E3-1]
      Pd = φc · Fcr · A
      = 0.9 × 51.25 × 820
      = 37.82 kN

 6. Compression ratio  [E3]
      |N| / Pd
      = 70.75 / 37.82
      = 1.871

 7. Governs
      the largest ratio
      = elastic buckling (E3-3)
      = 1.871

utilisation 1.871 -- OVER CAPACITY
```



Rod 3

utilisation 1.87 OVER

elastic buckling (E3-3)

```
Rod 3
=====
Steel, CIRSOC 301-2018 -- A = 820 mm², Fy = 235 MPa, L = 4.717 m

 1. Slenderness  [E2]
      K·L / r
      = 1 × 4,717 mm / 25.7 mm
      = 183.8

 2. Euler stress  [E3-4]
      Fe = π² E / (KL/r)²
      = π² × 200,000 / 183.8²
      = 58.43 MPa

 3. Which branch  [E3]
      KL/r ≤ 4.71 √(E/Fy) ?
      = 183.8 vs 4.71 √(200,000/235) = 137.4
      = elastic

 4. Critical stress  [E3-3]
      Fcr = 0.877 · Fe
      = 0.877 × 58.43
      = 51.25 MPa

 5. Design strength  [E3-1]
      Pd = φc · Fcr · A
      = 0.9 × 51.25 × 820
      = 37.82 kN

 6. Compression ratio  [E3]
      |N| / Pd
      = 70.75 / 37.82
      = 1.871

 7. Governs
      the largest ratio
      = elastic buckling (E3-3)
      = 1.871

utilisation 1.871 -- OVER CAPACITY
```